(and may be called a BSSID, ESSID, and so on, depending on what it is identifying). Every device connected to that part of the network uses the same SSID to identify itself as part of the family, so to speak, when it wants to gain access to the network or verify the origin of a data packet it's sending over the network. Using SSID carries some security risk, however, because it can be detected by wardrivers and used to gain unauthorised access. Some network administrators, therefore, disable SSID.

SSL
Secure Sockets Layer, an Internet protocol that uses public-key and secret-key encryption to secure data sent from one server to another. It was developed by Netscape Communications to safeguard commercial transactions taking place over the otherwise insecure Internet.

Static IP address
See IP address.

Switch
A device in a network that selects the path that a data packet will take to its next destination. The switch opens and closes the electrical circuit to determine whether—and where—data will flow. On the Internet, the switch sits at the point that connects one network to another network.

TCP/IP
Transmission Control Protocol/Internet Protocol. TCP/IP is the method by which data is sent across the Internet. These two protocols were developed by the US military to allow computers to talk to each other over long-distance networks. IP determines how the data is formatted into smaller chunks called data packets and ensures that those packets are addressed correctly to reach the right destination. TCP is responsible for establishing a connection between the client computer and the server and actually transmitting the data packets. TCP/IP forms the basis of the Internet, and is built into every common modern operating